

CleanTech Open 2025: Scorer & Evaluation Manual

Step-by-step instructions for evaluating startup applications, utilizing the AI Due Diligence Copilot, and navigating founder deliverables with auto-citation jumping.

Target: Expert Judges,
Mentors & Investors

Portal URL: <https://cleantech-scoring-2025.vercel.app/index.html>

Evaluation Framework: 10
Categories (282 Criteria)

1 Getting Started & Logging In

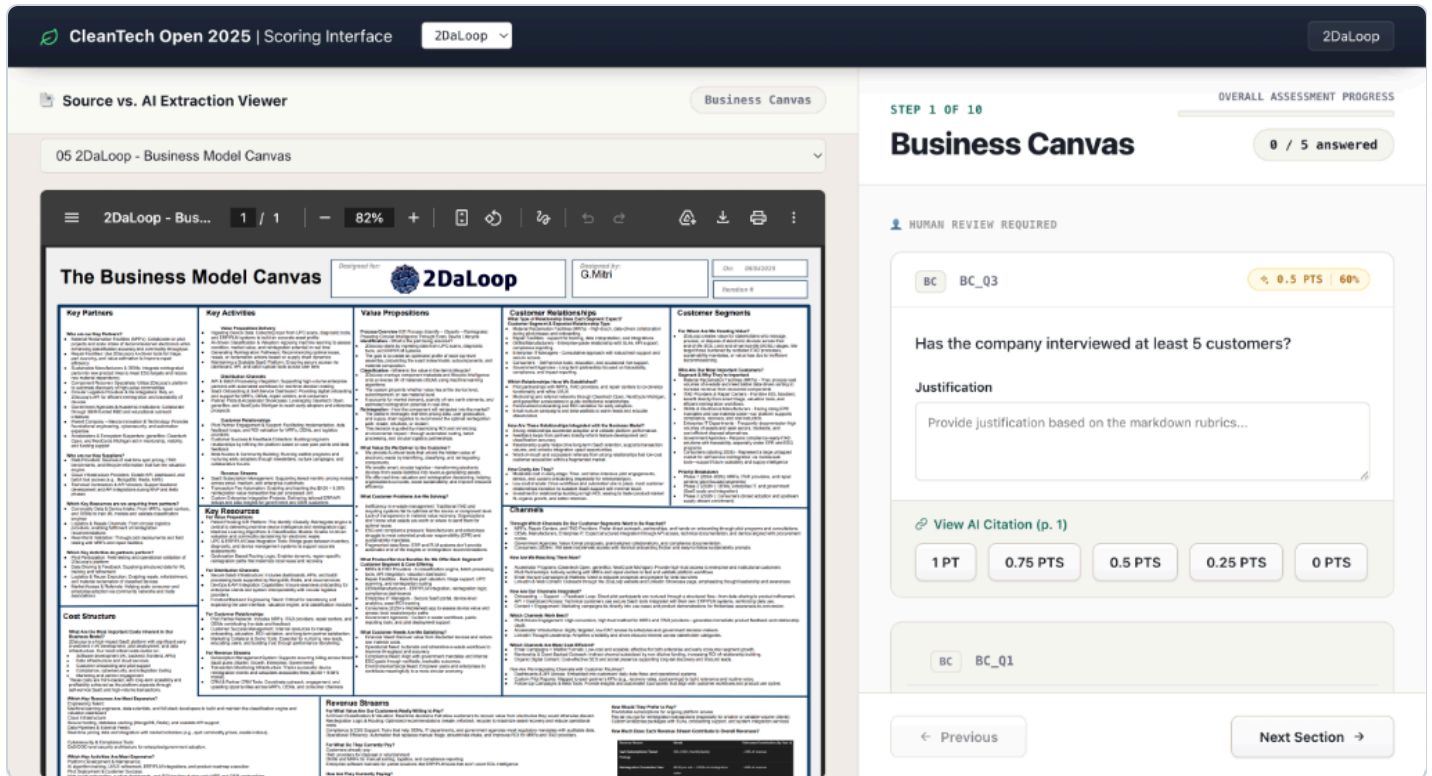
As a CleanTech Open judge, you have been assigned specific cleantech startups to evaluate. Your evaluations determine accelerator cohort admissions, awards, and investment readiness.

1. Navigate to the scoring portal at <https://cleantech-scoring-2025.vercel.app/index.html>.
2. In the **Judge Authentication** modal, enter:
 - **Scorer ID:** Your assigned username (e.g., judge_smith or J-001).
 - **Passcode:** Your individual access passcode provided by the administrator.
3. Click **Sign In**.
4. In the top dark navigation bar, click the **Company Dropdown** to view the startups assigned to you. Select the startup you wish to evaluate to load its application workspace.

Cloud Auto-Save: Every score selection and justification note is **automatically saved to the Supabase database** the moment you click a score or pause typing. You can safely reload the page or return on another device without losing work.

2 The Split-Screen Evaluation Workspace

The CleanTech Open scoring interface features a high-velocity **Side-by-Side Split Workspace** designed to eliminate window tab flipping. The left panel is dedicated to original founder deliverables, while the right panel displays your active scoring rubric and AI guidance.



Workspace Layout Overview

LEFT PANEL: Source vs. AI Extraction Viewer

- **Deliverable Selector Dropdown:** Switch between any uploaded PDF for the active evaluation module (e.g., *05 2DaLoop - Business Model Canvas*).
- **Module Tag:** Displays current category context (e.g. Business Canvas).
- **Integrated PDF Viewer:** Complete in-browser document reader with zoom (+/-), page jump, rotation, pan, print, and local download.
- **Auto-Jumping Canvas:** Automatically snaps to the exact page when an AI citation is clicked on the right!

RIGHT PANEL: Step-by-Step Scoring & Rubric

- **Module Step Indicator:** Shows current section (e.g., STEP 1 OF 10) and live progress (e.g., 0 / 5 answered).
- **Overall Assessment Progress Bar:** Visual progress tracking completion across all 282 criteria.
- **Evaluation Cards:** Scrollable criteria cards containing rubric text, AI suggestion pills, and point selectors.
- **Section Footer:** ← Previous and Next Section → buttons to transition between modules.

3 The AI Copilot & The Mandatory Human Review Rule



CRITICAL PROTOCOL: HUMAN REVIEW IS MANDATORY REGARDLESS OF AI CONFIDENCE

Never rubber-stamp high-confidence AI suggestions. An AI confidence rating of 90%, 95%, or 100% does **NOT** mean the startup's claim is commercially viable, technically sound, or factually true in the real world.

- **What AI Confidence Actually Measures:** The AI confidence score solely reflects *how clearly an explicit textual statement was found* in the founder's uploaded text. If a founder writes "Our technology has zero competitors and 100% customer retention", the AI will extract a high-confidence match (1.0 PT | 95% Conf).
- **What the AI Cannot Do:** The AI cannot verify whether the founder's claim is realistic, whether lab data supports it, whether customer interviews were genuine, or whether the competitive analysis is superficial.
- **Your Role as an Expert Judge:** You **must click the citation link**, review the cited passage in the PDF viewer on the left, inspect the surrounding context, and determine whether the startup genuinely satisfied the standard. **You have full authority to override the AI whenever founder evidence lacks depth or credibility.**

Anatomy of an Interactive Evaluation Card

Each evaluation card in the right panel is structured for rapid diligence and transparent accountability:

EVALUATION CARD BREAKDOWN

MODULE: BUSINESS CANVAS (BC)

HUMAN REVIEW REQUIRED

0.5 PTS | 60% Conf

BC BC_Q3

Has the company interviewed at least 5 customers?

Justification

View Examples

Provide justification based on the markdown rubrics...

View AI Citation (p. 1)

05_2DaLoop_Business_Model_Canvas.pdf

"Interviews we've completed before (NSF I-Corps) indicates that enterprise IT managers require standardized SLA guarantees..."

Switched viewer to Page 1. Use **Cmd+F** / **Ctrl+F** in the viewer to locate exact text.

1 PT

0.75 PTS

0.5 PTS

0.25 PTS

0 PTS

4 The 10 Evaluation Categories

Judges evaluate startups across 10 standardized modules. Use the *Next Section* → and ← *Previous* buttons at the bottom of the right panel to move sequentially through each section:

Code	Module Title	Questions	Primary Deliverable(s) Reviewed in Left Panel
BC	Business Canvas	5 Questions (BC_Q1–Q5)	Business Model Canvas (EBD1) & Customer Discovery capture
ES	Environmental & Social	10 Questions (ES_Q1–Q10)	Impact Statement (EBD2) & Sustainability module questions
F	Financials	29 Questions (F_Q1–Q29)	3-Year Financial Projections (EBD5) & unit economics model
IP	Investor Pitch	58 Questions (IP_Q1–Q58)	Investor Pitch Deck (EBD8) & full diligence slide presentation
IS	Executive Summary	34 Questions (IS_Q1–Q34)	1-Page Executive Summary (EBD6) & core company narrative
L	Legal & Governance	53 Questions (L_Q1–Q53)	IP filings, corporate formation, governance & legal review
M	Market & Customers	12 Questions (M_Q1–Q12)	Customer Segmentation & Competitive Matrix (EBD3)
PMF	Product Market Fit	34 Questions (PMF_Q1–Q34)	Customer interviews, discovery log & target customer segments
T	Team Targets	31 Questions (T_Q1–Q31)	Team hiring plans, targets & milestones
TP	Tech / Product	16 Questions (TP_Q1–Q16)	Technology Validation (EBD4) & Technical testimonials
TOTAL	10 Evaluation Categories	282 Questions Total	Standardized CleanTech Open Diligence Rubric

5 Step-by-Step Diligence Checklist

Follow this standardized 5-step workflow for every startup assigned to you:

Step	Action	Description & Best Practice
Step 1	Executive Summary	Start in the Executive Summary (IS) category to read the founder's 1-page overview and understand the core thesis.
Step 2	Category Progression	Progress systematically through the 10 categories using the bottom navigation buttons. Watch the overall progress bar fill.
Step 3	Inspect Citations	On each question, click "View AI Citation" to verify the founder's claim against the embedded PDF deliverable on the left.
Step 4	Record Score & Notes	Select your point verdict. If the question requires justification or if you disagree with the AI, type your brief explanation.
Step 5	Final Verification	Click "Confirm & Submit" when prompted to finalize and flush all scores to the database.

6 Comprehensive Scorer FAQs & Diligence Knowledge Base

Business Model Canvas: Large vs. Small Brackets (BC_Q4 vs. BC_Q5)

A frequent question from evaluators is distinguishing between **"Large Brackets"** and **"Small Brackets"** on the Business Model Canvas (Strategyzer 9-block framework):

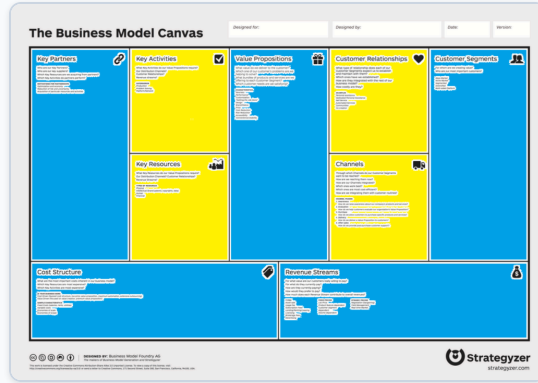


Figure: Strategyzer Business Model Canvas — Blue Blocks = Large Brackets (BC_Q4), Yellow Blocks = Small Brackets (BC_Q5).

Rubric ID	Bracket Classification	Strategyzer Color	Included Business Model Components
BC_Q4	Large / Big Brackets (Core Structural Pillars)	Blue Blocks	1. Key Partners · 2. Value Propositions · 3. Customer Segments · 4. Cost Structure · 5. Revenue Streams
BC_Q5	Small / Connecting Brackets (Operational Connectors)	Yellow Blocks	1. Key Activities · 2. Key Resources · 3. Customer Relationships · 4. Channels

Pro-Tip: The 4 corner boxes + center value proposition form the **Large Brackets (5)**. The operational connecting boxes form the **Small Brackets (4)**. Both combined encompass all 9 blocks of the canonical Business Model Canvas.

Deliverables, Sourcing & External Research

Q: Can I Google search if I cannot find information in the startup's submitted files?

A: Yes. You are explicitly authorized and encouraged to Google search the company, visit their website, inspect founder LinkedIn profiles, and review public press releases or patent filings if a question cannot be answered from their submitted files.

Q: What if a company has files but no dedicated Business Model Canvas (BMC) document?

A: Review their other submitted deliverables (e.g. Investor Pitch Deck, Executive Summary, Customer Discovery log) and web search to evaluate their business model as best as possible. Award 0 PTS only if no business model information exists across all materials.

Q: What if a company has missing files or access is blocked?

A: If all materials for a company are completely missing, notify the administrator. If an application survey text exists, evaluate based on that text. For any question where no evidence exists anywhere, award **0 PTS**.

Q: Which should I score if both Application Phase and EBD Phase versions exist?

A: Always evaluate the **Essential Business Deliverables (EBD) Phase** files. EBD represents the finalized, post-program deliverables (e.g. validated financial models, customer interview sheets). Only reference early Application Phase survey answers if an EBD document is absent.

Module Scoping, Jargon & Scoring Scale

Q: Are question categories strictly scoped to specific deliverables, or can I cross-reference?

A:

- **Strict Scoping:** *Business Canvas (BC)*, *Executive Summary (IS)*, and *Investor Pitch (IP)* must be evaluated primarily on their respective deliverables (EBD1, EBD6, EBD8).
- **Flexible Scoping:** For all other categories (Financials, Tech Validation, Market, Product-Market Fit, Team, Legal, Environmental Impact), you are free to cross-reference any submitted file or online source to verify founder assertions.

Q: How should I score technical buzzwords or industry jargon?

A: 1–2 technical or domain-specific terms used to explain their core innovation are acceptable. However, if the submission relies on excessive, unexplained buzzwords that obscure their real business model or technology, penalize their clarity score.

Q: Do I need to calculate weights, averages, or formula scores?

A: No. In historical spreadsheets, reviewers had to deal with complex decimal weights. The modern Diligence Engine standardizes all 282 criteria onto a clean **0 to 1 point scale** (0, 0.25, 0.5, 0.75, 1.0 PTS). The platform handles all aggregation, category rollups, and cohort scoring automatically.

Q: Why do some questions show legacy numbers like (1-5) or (0.44) in the prompt?

A: These numbers are preserved from the original rubric questions for provenance. Simply select the appropriate score button on the standardized 0 – 1 point scale based on the criteria thresholds.

Q: Should I recalibrate my scores after finishing?

A: Yes. Once you complete scoring all assigned startups, take 5 minutes to review your score distribution across your cohort to ensure your evaluation rigor remained consistent from your first company to your last.

Platform Capabilities & Persistence

Q: What if the AI Citation says "No direct evidence exists"?

A: This means the AI did not locate explicit text matching this criterion. If you independently search the document and cannot locate evidence, award **0 PTS**.

Q: Can I view the official rubric scoring guidelines?

A: Yes! On questions with official rubric guidelines (e.g. Business Canvas), click the " **View Examples**" link in the question card to view rubric thresholds and real-world grading examples calibrated directly to the **0 – 1 point scale**.

Q: What happens if I close my browser before clicking Submit?

A: All scores and justifications are continuously saved to the Supabase database in real time. When you reopen the portal, all your answers will automatically reload from the database.